

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Created in God's Image

A free resource from JesusOnline Ministries.

Read or share online: app.jesonline.com/post/22300-004-created-in-gods-image

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

Created in God's Image

Day 4

Then God said, "Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over the cattle, over all the earth and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth." So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them.... Then God saw everything that He had made and indeed it was very good. (Genesis 1:26-27, 31)

God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit worked together to create humankind. God said, "Let Us make man *in Our image*...." We were created in the likeness of God. Animals weren't created in God's image. Angels weren't created in God's image. But we are!

We are made in the likeness of God. We are made to call the same things "good"—laughter, friendship, kindness. We are made to hate the same evils—cheating, hunger, violence. God is the creator of life; He made the universe and all it contains. And so we too create; we build houses, weave tapestries, paint pictures, and plant gardens.

God made you and me in His image to enjoy the same life of fellowship the Trinity enjoys. We were created to live in relationship with God—in the Trinity's shared enjoyment and delight, affection and adoration. We were fashioned by a God of love, in an act of love, to be recipients of love and to be streams of love flowing back to God and out to our fellow human beings. We were made for loving relationships with God, self, others, and creation.

In order to live life as God intends, He fashioned us to be of three parts; we are *spirit*, *soul*, and *body*. Our *spirit* is the resting place for God's Spirit. Our *soul* defines our nature; it is our mind, will, and emotions that make up our unique self. Our *body* is the physical covering for the spirit and soul within.

When spirit, soul, and body are in agreement with God, the rulership He gave us to exercise on earth expresses His nature. God created humanity to "have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the air, and over the cattle, over all the

earth.” He intends that we exercise the dominion He entrusted to us by living in agreement with Him—in His relational lovingkindness.

In God’s plan, our spirit becomes a resting place for His Spirit, and our mind, will, and emotions are transformed by His Spirit so that our body radiates the nature of God. In this way, the life and love of God is like a spring bubbling up within us, restoring our soul as it flows out of us as a refreshing stream.

After completing each day of creation, “God saw that it was *good*” (Genesis 1:10, 12, 18, 21, 25). But on the day He created Adam, “God saw everything that He had made, and indeed it was *very good*.”

What did God see that caused Him to call creation, after it was completed with humanity, not just “*good*,” but “*very good*?” He saw someone like Himself with whom He could have a relationship. Now He could share Himself with beings who had the capacity to understand Him—to resonate with Him. He could give Himself to someone who could appreciate Him and who could, of their own choice, love Him back. And those people could love others and care for creation by sharing His love. Now *agape* could expand itself; God could give away His self-giving love.

God loves you with the very same everlasting love He shares within Himself. You were made to know and enjoy the same relationships of total honesty, adoration and delight the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit share. Your soul needs laughter, friendship, kindness. You were designed to be cherished and valued.

And God cherishes and values you! God calls you “*very good*.” He made you to thrive in relationship with Him. You were made for life in God’s love.

Ponder for a Moment

What does it mean to you personally that you were made in God’s image?

How does it make you feel to be called the “*very good*” of God’s creation?

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → equip.jesonline.com/reviews/share

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping